

Chapter 191 - Part 1

Extra 13-1

Gu Yixue had always remembered when she first arrived at the Gu family.

Back then, she was still a thin, frail little girl with barely any meat on her bones. Plus, with her big eyes, even just looking at people plainly made it seem like she was glaring at them.

Gu Chunmian's mother said she was an ungrateful wretch—even if raised by their side for many years, she couldn't be tamed. Who knew when she might bite back.

Back then, Gu Yixue didn't even dare look in the mirror, didn't dare run around in the Gu family's big villa.

The Gu family arranged a room for her.

Even as an illegitimate daughter, they didn't mistreat her in terms of food, clothing, and necessities. The butler took her to a very large room where four or five of her could lie on the bed, yet she only slept at the edge of the bed. One night, she even rolled off the bed.

However, she lived on the second floor, while Gu Chunmian was on the top floor.

The rooms alone established their positions.

Gu Chunmian had to suppress her in everything.

Because Gu Chunmian was the Gu family's legal heir.

Gu Yixue didn't really care about these things. She just didn't like Mrs. Gu's gaze, and occasionally she would say to her face: "Just like that dead vixen mother of yours."

Gu Yixue wanted to refute, but remembering what her mother said before dying, she swallowed all her rebuttals.

Her mother had told her very early on: Be obedient.

Gu Yixue didn't manage it elsewhere, but she did in the Gu family.

However, one day she ran around.

Because Gu Chunmian had snatched away the pendant her mother left her and thrown it somewhere.

At that time, Gu Chunmian was already about to enter high school, while Gu Yixue was still an elementary school student.

She wasn't popular at school either, because there was a girl in her class who liked forming cliques, who happened to be the younger sister of one of Gu Chunmian's classmates.

Gu Chunmian normally spoke without restraint, calling Gu Yixue "bastard" and "illegitimate daughter" at every turn.

So these names all reached her classmates' ears.

She would occasionally hear everyone calling her these names.

Even worse, during PE class when the teacher wasn't paying attention, the mischievous boys in class would throw basketballs at her head.

When she covered her head and looked over, they would dribble the basketball past her casually, raising their eyebrows in contempt with a light, dismissive laugh: "Little bastard."

That day, Gu Yixue got into a fight with boys bigger than herself and was covered in mud.

When she went back, someone told on her. Her father, who was usually too busy to even come home, happened to be home that day. Seeing her with injuries on her face, he was especially angry.

So she knelt on the cold floor of the living room and took a beating.

Her father had a stick—thin and long, of unknown material. When it hit her back, it wasn't surface pain but pain that seeped into the bone marrow.

After just two strikes, she couldn't stand up.

Even so, she didn't cry. Tears just swirled in her eyes. Her eyes turned so red they seemed about to bleed, and she bit her lower lip tightly. The moment the stick landed on her body, she nearly bit through her lower lip.

Later, when she returned to her room, she took out the pendant her mother left her to look at. Gu Chunmian suddenly burst into her room, looking down at her with mockery: "I heard you got into a fight? Father hates fighting the most..."

Gu Yixue didn't acknowledge her, didn't even lift her head to look. She just kept her head down, eyes staring directly at the pendant in her hand.

Ignored, Gu Chunmian followed her gaze and discovered the pendant inlaid with a red gemstone.

The red gemstone had vivid colors and looked quite valuable.

But most importantly, this thing was very important to Gu Yixue.

So Gu Chunmian wanted to destroy it.

Gu Chunmian reached out and snatched it away, turning to run outside.

Gu Yixue's palm was cut with a deep mark from the chain. Momentarily stunned, when she turned around, Gu Chunmian had already run downstairs.

That was probably the fastest Gu Yixue, who wasn't good at sports, had ever run.

But their physical strength was too disparate—she used all her energy but still couldn't catch up to Gu Chunmian.

When Gu Chunmian got tired of running, she threw the item forward.

The pendant traced a beautiful arc through the air and fell into a flower bed.

The flower bed was being replanted because Mrs. Gu wanted to see fresh roses. The soil had just been turned over and watered, so full it was almost overflowing.

The pendant fell into it, not a trace visible.

Gu Yixue ran over, her calves sinking into the flower bed, mud flying everywhere.

She searched for a long time, feeling inch by inch, but still couldn't find the pendant.

Suddenly, she heard a cold voice: "That's going a bit too far."

Because the voice was so pleasant, Gu Yixue, who was bent over searching for the pendant, couldn't help but turn her head. She saw a girl wearing the same school uniform as Gu Chunmian standing there, her delicate brows slightly furrowed, expression indifferent, looking in her direction.

"Who told her to be annoying." Gu Chunmian said matter-of-factly: "She actually dared to ignore me! Shen Fenghe, aside from you, who else dares to ignore me?"

Shen Fenghe gave a light scoff. Another girl standing with Shen Fenghe also rolled her eyes, "Gu Chunmian, you're way too arrogant. Which law says people must pay attention to you?"

"It's different." Gu Chunmian's face reddened from being called out, but still insisted: "Her mom is a shameless vixen, she's a bastard who can't see the light. My mom said from now on she has to listen to me. She's our family's dog—when I call her, she must respond to me!"

The young girl's self-respect vanished completely in this moment.

Her dignity was thrown on the ground and trampled.

Although this type of talk wasn't the first time Gu Chunmian had said it, at this moment, coming from her mouth so seriously and methodically, it was hard not to believe it was true.

Of course, to a large extent, this was the truth.

It was the truth in Gu Chunmian's world.

It was also the Gu family's collective understanding.

The only one still holding onto a thread of fantasy was Gu Yixue.

And in this moment, Gu Yixue's fantasy was also trampled on the ground.

She was merely supposed to be one of Gu Chunmian's dogs.

Gu Yixue bent over, all her tears falling to the ground, creating ripples on the calm, dirty water surface.

She continued searching for her pendant.

She didn't know if it was her imagination, but she heard that pleasant voice say contemptuously: "Absurd."

Then, as she was searching for the pendant, that person stood by the flower bed and said coldly: "Come here."

Gu Yixue's back stiffened, but she didn't acknowledge her.

Chapter 191 - Part 2

Extra 13-2

After a while, Gu Yixue felt her body become light—her whole person was suspended in mid-air.

From that time on, Shen Fenghe was already taller than her peers, with more mature thinking and greater strength, so she could easily lift the thin and frail Gu Yixue.

Shen Fenghe rolled up her pant legs, placed Gu Yixue on the edge of the flower bed, then asked in a low voice: "What did she throw away?"

Gu Yixue pressed her lips together: "A pen... pendant."

"What color?" Shen Fenghe asked again.

Gu Yixue: "Red..."

Shen Fenghe asked again: "How big?"

Gu Yixue gestured with her hand to show her, then Shen Fenghe rolled up her uniform sleeves.

Her arms were especially white. Back then, she wore her hair in a ponytail and wore no makeup.

But her figure from behind as she bent over searching for the pendant fell into young Gu Yixue's eyes like a deity.

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Gu Yixue suddenly woke with a start.

When she woke, it was nearly dawn. Through the gap in the curtains, faint light could be seen. She checked the time—it wasn't even six o'clock yet.

But it was already sunrise time.

Perhaps because she'd had an unpleasant birthday, or perhaps because she'd been too exhausted lately.

Last night, Gu Yixue had dreamed of that incident again.

Later, it became a ball of light enveloping Shen Fenghe, then suddenly the scene changed and she actually heard Shen Fenghe say: "Let's get divorced."

And then she woke up startled, her back covered in cold sweat.

This dream was also quite absurd.

It was also the first time reality and dreams had intertwined together.

Gu Yixue felt her throat was a bit dry and wanted to smoke, but didn't want to show this in front of Shen Fenghe.

Though it was midsummer, she felt cold.

Shen Fenghe had very good sleeping posture—she wouldn't change positions throughout the night.

Last night after they finished, Gu Yixue didn't want to go shower, so she dawdled and acted cute wanting Shen Fenghe to carry her.

Then she nearly fell asleep in the bathtub.

Anyway, she dozed off in the bathtub, and when she woke up, Shen Fenghe was already using a bath towel to dry her body.

Gu Yixue often couldn't figure out what Shen Fenghe was thinking.

Always keeping her at arm's length.

Say she was good to her—not that good.

But say she wasn't good to her—she always touched Gu Yixue in those small details.

Those were moments Gu Yixue needed but that no one had ever paid attention to.

After a night had passed, Shen Fenghe still had her arm under Gu Yixue's neck. Just a slight pull would bring Gu Yixue into her embrace.

Gu Yixue, taking advantage of the fact she wasn't awake yet, quietly rolled over, her head settling into the hollow of her shoulder.

Shen Fenghe also slept lightly. With this movement, she woke up too.

But she only squinted once, then closed her eyes again. Her arm drew back, pulling Gu Yixue into her embrace. Her dry lips lightly touched Gu Yixue's forehead, and her breathing became steady again.

Seemed to have fallen back asleep.

Yes, it was this dragonfly-kiss on the forehead that made Gu Yixue feel that Shen Fenghe did like her.

Even if not as much as work, she still cared.

Gu Yixue's mood was somewhat dejected. Thinking about having to face such high-pressure filming after getting up made her head ache.

Her chin rubbed against Shen Fenghe's shoulder. Shen Fenghe asked in a low voice: "What's wrong?"

Still carrying the hoarseness of not being fully awake.

"I had a dream." Gu Yixue said.

Shen Fenghe asked groggily: "What dream?"

Gu Yixue pressed her lips together and moved closer, her lips touching her throat as she said softly: "I dreamed about that time when Gu Chunmian threw away my pendant."

Shen Fenghe frowned, as if recalling, then said after a moment: "That was so long ago."

"Very, very long ago." Gu Yixue said.

Shen Fenghe agreed: "Yes."

As she spoke, her hand suddenly pinched the back of Gu Yixue's neck, then she gave a rare smile, "You're still as thin as before."

Gu Yixue closed her eyes: "Am I?"

"Quite thin." Shen Fenghe said: "Eat more."

"I know."

After Gu Yixue answered, the room fell quiet.

Until Gu Yixue suddenly asked: "Elder sister, do you hate me?"

Shen Fenghe immediately opened her eyes, staring straight at her: "What do you mean?"

"Just that... the person who ended up marrying you was me, not Gu Chunmian." When Gu Yixue said this, she held her breath, afraid of missing even one of Shen Fenghe's micro-expressions, and tentatively said: "If you had married Gu Chunmian, things would probably be much easier now, right?"

Shen Fenghe pressed her brow, lying flat, and withdrew her arm.

Gu Yixue's neck suddenly felt empty.

Shen Fenghe fished her underwear from the side, reaching behind to fasten the clasps, while asking very seriously: "What are you thinking about?"

Gu Yixue also sat up, hugging her from behind.

Having been too lazy to put on pajamas after finishing last night, their skin pressed together in an instant.

Gu Yixue's body temperature was noticeably lower than Shen Fenghe's.

Gu Yixue said: "Can't you tell?"

Shen Fenghe pressed her lips together: "You should speak directly."

Gu Yixue paused slightly, lowering her head with a smile: "What I mean is, do you regret marrying me?"

Shen Fenghe: "..."

Shen Fenghe turned and pressed her down on the bed, her breath entirely falling on her face, "Thank you for helping me out that day."

Gu Yixue looked into her eyes and froze for a moment, her heart racing wildly.

Shen Fenghe said again: "You are my wife, I will fulfill my obligations properly."

It was like a bucket of cold water poured over her head.

Gu Yixue's heart stopped beating in that instant.